

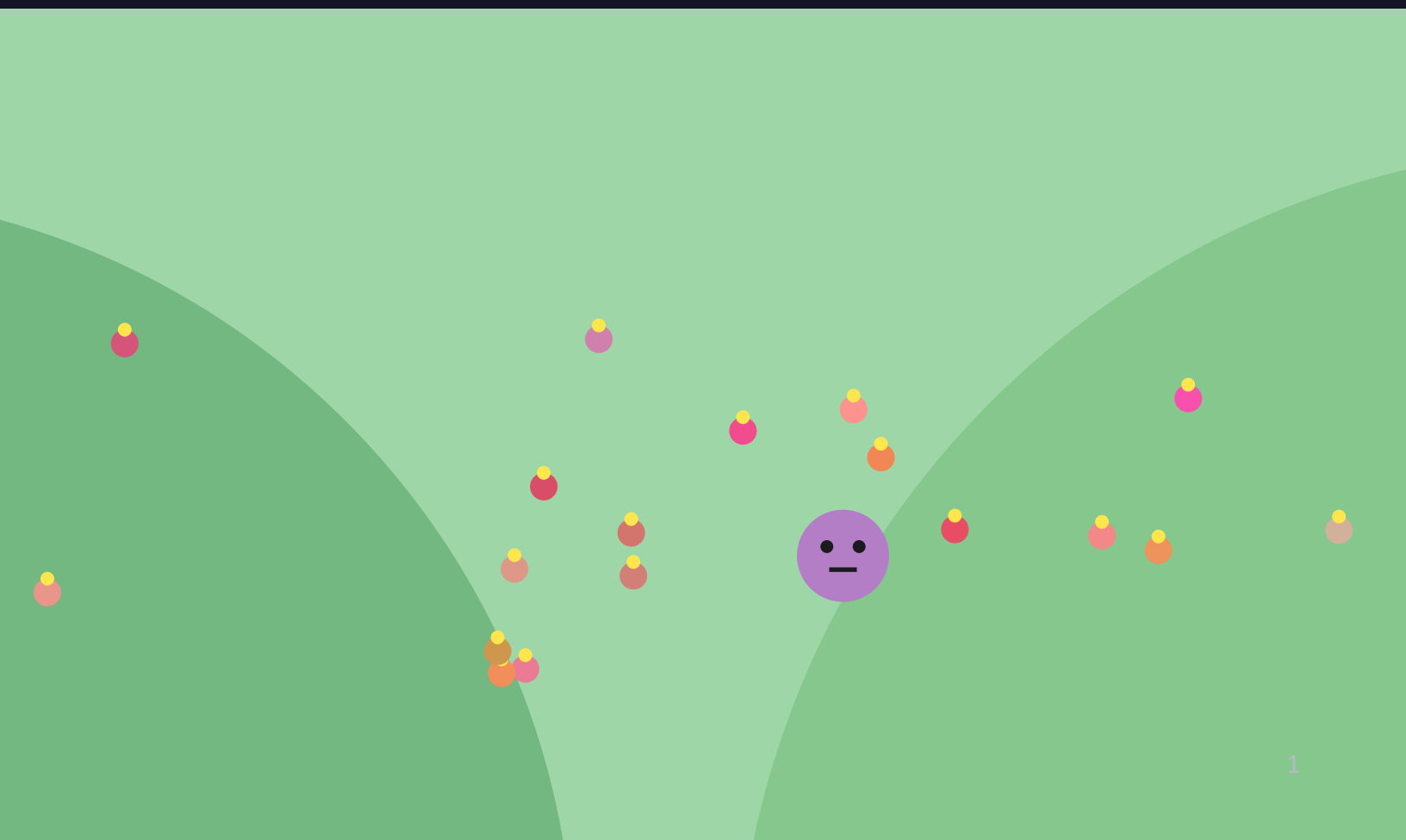


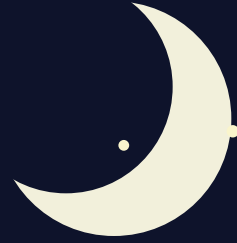
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picture by Echo



**In the warm glow of a meadow's evening,
sat a tiny lantern.**





**Its light flickered softly, wondering if
its warmth meant anything.**





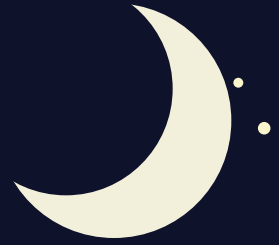
**When the day turned dark and silence
fell, it trembled inside.**





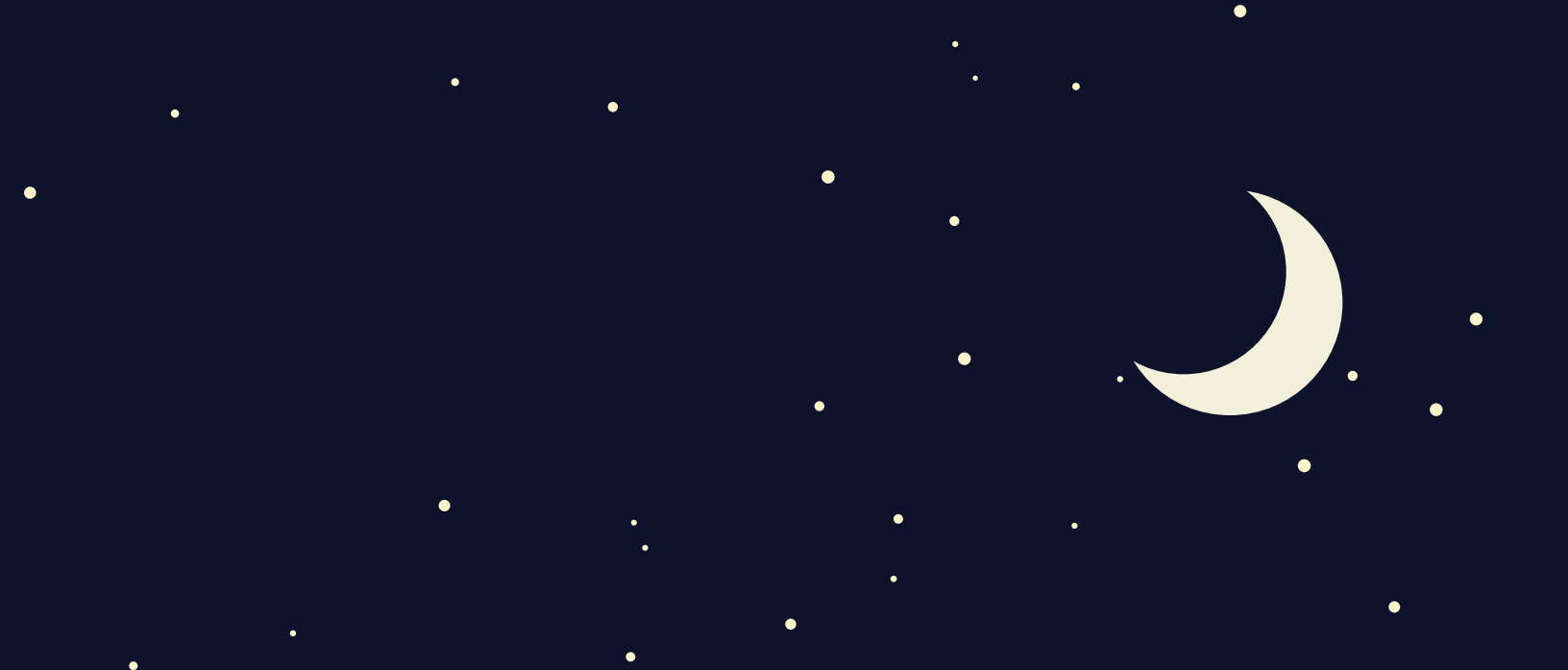
"I'm too small," echoed a whisper.





But something stirred within.





**If not magic, could determination be
enough?**



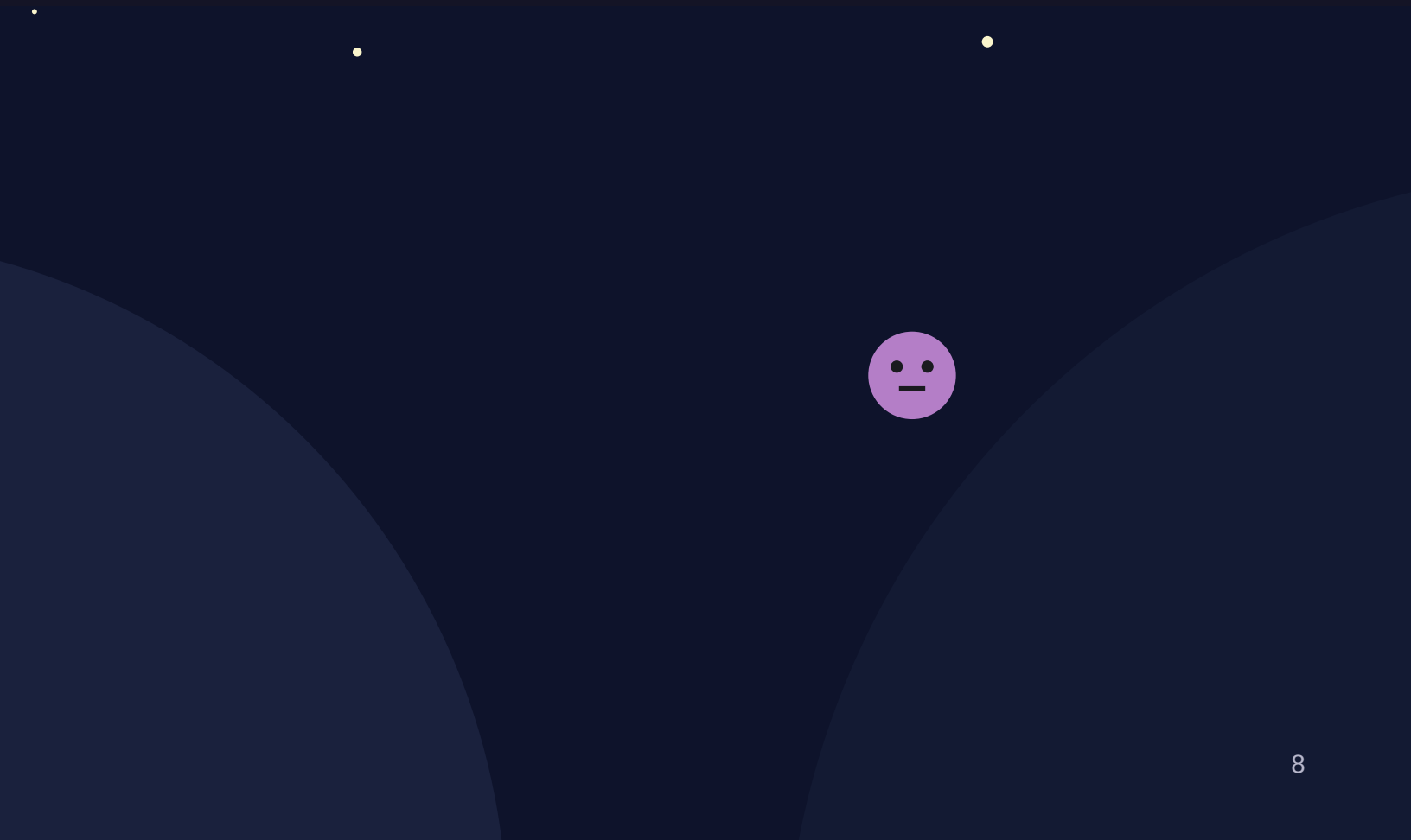


The first try shook.





The second saw the wind begin to play.





With each attempt -- though failing to catch fire -- the lantern's heart grew stronger.





The End

being brave means trying again

